

Variable Descriptions

Each variable which is used in the database is described below. Each feature lists at least one example for every possible value that has been encountered.

Each entry below is structured as follows:

```
#### Variable Type _(Value code: Value meaning, ...)_  
Plain text description ...  
  
Description of how different values can trigger NA in hierarchically subordinate features.  
  
- Example or clarification of edge-case
```

Boolean (0: *False*; 1: *True*)

We distinguish between *true boolean* features marked as '*boolean*' and *ternary* variables. True booleans require a TRUE (1) or FALSE (0) response to the question being posed. This type of feature is designed to capture basic facts about a *tradition*, generally assessing the presence or absence of certain characteristics.

A 0 triggers the value NA value for all hierarchically dependent features.

Ternary (0: *absent*, 1: *present*, 2: *forbidden*)

Ternary *boolean-like* variables ask whether a tradition allows, requires or forbids the presence of a certain characteristics. These are kept distinct from *true* Boolean since, under certain circumstances, the absence of a perk is not seen as prohibiting, but rather as irrelevant to a given tradition.

A 2 triggers the value NA value in all hierarchically dependent features.

Categorical (*unique per variable*)

If a logical variable is not sufficient to capture what a feature intends to describe, categorical variables are employed.

The possible values of a categorical variable are given in brackets (separated by ;) after the variable type descriptor in any feature-index.

Each possible value is described in its own right within the feature-description of each feature which is described by a categorical variable.

Ordinal (*choose from the suggested list*)

This hybrid between the categorical and numeric variable types is employed where a clearly transitive relation between the possible values exists, but a numeric variable type seems inappropriate. The possible values are unique to each feature and listed given in the feature descriptions.

Lists of possible values are always given in ascending order: E.g. LP052 How many vocal performers can maximally perform a poem? lists as possible values: one, two and many.

Tag set (*unique per variable*)

Mostly the same as *Categorical* with the exception that we accept the addition of new values where necessary, whereas the possible values for *Categorical* variables are fixed at feature creation and may not be extended. For each individual *feature* (Features) the list of approved tags can be found in its description.

While new entries are allowed, the database holders will only add new tags to the set of recommended features if they seem reasonably applicable across different cultural areas and *metric systems*. (In order to avoid an exponential growth of hapax-legomena tags.)

For specific tag sets see below in this document

Numeric (*integer*)

In features labelled 'numeric', the value entered must be an integer (i.e. a natural number $\mathbf{Z}_0$). If the value for a feature asking for a numeral is explicitly infinite, use *.

- In Old Saxon poetry, the number of *L1-unit types* is very high and may even be infinite. However, there is no description of a unified set of *L1-rules* and *L2-rules*, which could guarantee infinity. Hence we cannot conclusively state that the number of *L1-unit types* is unbounded and report the highest number of *L1-unit types* found in the literature.
- However, if the *performance* of a *composition* requires active participation by an entire village or tribe we encode * rather than the highest known population of the village/tribe, since the custom states that everyone (however many that may be) is required to participate as a performer.

Date (*year: past date; *: extant date*)

A sub-type of the numeric variable type used exclusively in LP021 and LP022. It differs from numeric variables in that we use CE (common era) and BCE (before common era) to differentiate between *positive* and *negative* values and in that dates are never to be understood as aggregated values.

Each entry is to be entered in the format: (ca) YYYY (CE|BCE) or, if a tradition is still in use, * is entered alternatively.

- E.g. a tradition which has been identified as originating «in the late 4th century before Christ» would be entered as: 300 BCE
- If the uncertainty exceeds 200 years, we encode the mean of the range and add ca; e.g. a tradition which has been identified as originating «in the first millennium before Christ» would be entered as: ca 500 BCE.
- Extant traditions are encoded as *
- An unknown date is encoded as ?

Plain text (*text*)

Plain text fields are included to give background information or add detail to what has been coded. They cannot be used for statistical interpretation, but may be used in the future in case further features are introduced. For this type of feature, it is generally indicated if some specific kind of formatting is required, such as in LP000 where sources are to be listed as BibTeX items.

The following formatting rules apply to all plain text fields:

- Quotes are to be delimited by the single ('..cite..') or french («..cite..») quotation marks. The

use of double quotation marks " is forbidden since they have a tendency to mess with the text delimiters used in .csv files.

- Citations are to be given in brackets at the end of a line or paragraph using bibtex keys followed by a colon : and the page reference without any intervening blanks; multiple pages are separated by a semicolon ; , eg. (hudak1986:32;66;passim); see the literature page on citation standards and more details.
- The default format of our *documentation files* is markdown. Please keep in mind while writing your reports that some special characters may interfere with markdown syntax. In case of doubt delimit a messy paragraph with ```&*&%``` or use \ to escape single characters (e.g. * instead of *).
- In case you add a screenshot or other pictures as part of your documentation files, please make sure that these are stored in the same file as the documentation file (otherwise, the .md file wont display them).

NA (NA: *inherited inapplicability*)

NA (not applicable) is understood in such a way that this value may override the expected value choices for a variable if a hierarchically superordinate variable or a property of a languoid has been answered with a logically negative value. (0 for *Boolean*, 2 for *Ternary*, empty set for *Categorical* or *Tag set*)

E.g. feature LP053 asks whether a *tradition* is performed with instrumental musical accompaniment. If the answer is 0, the follow-up question in LP054 *Who accompanies the performance musically?* is to be answered as NA.

irrelevant (*irrelevant: irrelevant property*)

If a linguistic property is part of a languoid's linguistic system but does not contribute to the poetic system the languoid is used for the property variable is coded as irrelevant.

? (?: *insufficient data*)

If a feature has not been described in the literature to an extent that would allow encoding it, use ?. We make a clear distinction between logical inapplicability (encoded by NA) and insufficient description. This is, if a feature with hierarchically subordinate sub-features has been encoded as ?, the dependent features also inherit a ?, rather than an NA. And conversely, if a feature has been encoded as NA, dependent questions do not count as unanswerable due to lacking description (?), but as logically unanswerable (NA)

Tag sets

The tables below list the possible tags that indicate the typical use and thematic content of the PL-entity. Please identify the tags that best describe them. For convenience, we list them grouped into thematic areas; this grouping is irrelevant for coding.

Separate multiple tags with semicolon ;.

Religious context

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Undefined	Dance Song ; Mask Dance ; Processional Music ; Mass ; Music For Unscheduled Rites ; Popular religious song ; Processional Song

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Initiation	Initiation Rite ; Puberty Song ; Land Diver's Song ; Circumcision Song ; Baptism Song ; Initiation Song ; Childbirth Song ; Song For Newborn ; Adoption Song ;
Death	Funeral Song; Lament ; Mourning Song ; Death Song ; Wake Song ; For The Dead ; Song For The Dead ; For Ancestors ; Burial Song
Magic	Ritual Song ; Ceremonial Song ; Chant ; Cult Song ; Secret Society Song ; Magic Song ; Divinatory Song ; Possession Song ; Invocation Song ; Mystical Song ; Magics Song
Invocation	Animal Song ; Spirit Song ; Saint's Song ; Invocation ; Possession Song ; Trance Song ; Peyote Ceremony Song ; Dream Song ; Supplication Song ;
Prayer	Religious Song ; Prayer ; Spiritual ; Praise Song ; Devotional Song ; Morality Song ; Sacred Song ; Song For Deity ; Recitative ; Creation Song ; Prayers ;
Healing	Healing Song ; Shaman Song ; Herbalist's Song ; Meditative Song ; Medicine Song ; Exorcism Song ;
Protection	War Song ; Hunting Song ; War Dance Song ; Raiding Song ; Propitiatory Song ; Headhunting Song ; Supplication Song
Nature	Spring Song ; Mountain Song ; Rain Song ; River Song ; Air ; Field Song ; Lake Song ; Forest Song ; Evening Song ; Song About Nature ; Dawn Song ; Propitiatory Song ; Night Song ; Morning Song ; Tree Song ; Dusk Song ; Monsoon Song
Blessing	Wedding Song ; Building Completion Song ; Fertility Song ;
Sacrifice	Sacrificial Song ; Pig Song
Calendric	New Year Song ; Summer Solstice Song ; Song About Seasons ; Calendrical Rite ; Calendar Song

Social context

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Undefined	Folk Song ; Folk Lyric ; Folk
Dance	Dance Song ; Social Dance ; Round Dance ; Mask Dance ; Recreational Dance ;
Work	Work Song ; Chantey ; Boat Song ; Fisherman's Song ; Fishing Song ; Begging Song ; Building Completion Song ; Muleteer's Song ; Caravan Song ; Walking Song ; Lumberers' Song ; Sailor's Song ; Building Song ; Miner's Song ; Tobacco Workers' Song ; Artisans' Song ; Canoe-Making Song ; Cooking Song ; Spinning Song
Love	Love Song ; Adoration Song ; Love song ;
Community	Village Song ; Domestic Song ; Clan Song ; Potlatch Song ; Place Of Origin Song ; Elders' Song ; Nation Dance ; Name Song ; Adoption Song ; Gathering Song ; Pow Wow Song ; Market Song ; Song For Community Gathering ; Political Song

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Children	Lullaby ; Children's Song ; Childbirth Song ; Nursery Rhyme ; Childrens' Song ;
Entertainment	Game Song ; Daily-Life Song ; Drinking Song ; Throat Game ; Gambling Song ; Play Song ; Hand Game Song ; Stick Game Song ; Walking Song ; Festival Music ; Competitive Song ; Challenge Song
Celebratory	Festival Song ; Feast Song ; Entertainment Song ; Party Song ; Social Song ; Celebratory Song ; Wedding Song ; Fiesta Song ; Carnival Music ; Popular Song ; Processional Music ; Celebration Song ; Congratulatory Song ; Maypole Song ; Song For Cheering ;
Insult	Satirical Song ; Insult Song ; Teasing Song ; Song Of Derision ; Slander Song ; Critical Song ; Gossip Song ; Complaint Song
Humor	Comic Song ; Self-Delectative Song
Martial	Fight Song ; Marching Song ; Soldier's Song ; Training Song ; Song Of Victory ; Song Of Victory ; Song Of Victory ; Raiding Song ; Headhunting Song ; Military Song ;
Travel	Greeting Song ; Traveling Song ; Farewell Song ; Guest Song ; Welcome Song ; Song Of Arrival ; Immigration Song ; Gathering Song ; Visiting Song ; Farewell ; Migrant Song ; Walking Song ;
Agricultural	Rice Song; Herding Song ; Reaping Song ; Agricultural Song ; Agricultural work song for threshing ; Harvest Song ; Threshing Song ; Agricultural Song ; Planting Song ; Field Song ; Manioc Song ; Honey Song ; Corn Song ; Millet Song
Pastorial	Shepherd's Song ; Milking Song
Hunting	Hunting Song
Calendric	New Year Song ; Summer Solstice Song ; Song About Seasons ; Calendrical Rite ; Calendar Song
Political	Negotiation Song; Trading Song ; Protest Song

Other contexts

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Courtship	Love Song ; Courtship Song ; Cultivated Love Song ; Adoration Song ; Romance
Ballad	Ballad ; Ballad - Romance
Lament	Lament ; Dirge
Admiration	Hymn ; Anthem ; Patriotic Song ; Song About Nature
Praise	Song For Royalty ; Court Music ; Chief's Song
Artistry	Improvised Song
Performing Arts	Opera ; Acculturated Song ; Theater Music ; Lyric Song

Narrative contexts

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
Story	Story Song ; Narrative Song ; Topical Song ; Theater Music ;
Nationalist	Song For Royalty ; Song About Leadership ; Chief's Song ; Anthem
Mundane	Daily-Life Song ; Song About Seasons
Heroicism	Heroic Song ; Saint's Song ; Self-Praise Song ; Headhunting Song
Allegorical	Morality Song
Emotional	Drama ; Ballad - Romance ; Romance ; Romance-ballad ; Murder Ballad ; Song Of Joy
Lament	Prison Song ; Lament ; Sentimental Song ; Sad Song ; Slavery Song ; Military Song ; Orphan's Song

Historical contexts

PL-tag	Corresponding tags in the Global Jukebox
War	War Song ; Warrior's Song ; Soldier's Song ; Self-Praise Song ; Song Of Victory ; Song Of Victory ; Song Of Victory
Ancestors	Epic Song ; Song About Leadership ; Song For The Dead
History	Historical Song ; Nostalgic Song
National Myths	Anthem ; Patriotic Song
Historical Figures	Heroic Song ; Saint's Song
Creation Myth	Creation Song ; Mythical Song ; Mystical Song
